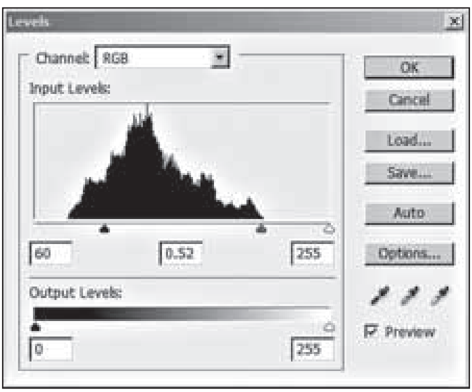
of the smallest detail within your image. The "amount" is indicative of the overall strength of your sharpening effect, listed mostly as a percentage value. You can always start with the 100% mark and work your way around. Finally you'll usually encounter a "threshold" setting too, which controls the minimum brightness change that will be sharpened, that can be used on pronounced edges while leaving the subtle ones untouched, especially helpful in avoiding sharpening noise. If available in certain software, you may also come across a setting similar to "detail", which allows you to relatively sharpen the fine versus coarse details within your fixed radius value, thus affecting the overall sharpening. Specialized techniques like local contrast enhancement may also be used in some cases. This aims at increasing the appearance of the large scale light- dark transitions, giving an image its "pop", creating three dimensional effects that mimic the look naturally created by high end cameras. Identical to sharpening using un-sharp masks, in Photoshop and other image editing programs, for applying this effect you can use the layers concept, except that the "radius" is much larger and "percentage" much lower.

Work with contrast and brightness

Usually after sharpening the image contrasts are adjusted. If you have clicked in a bright indoor lighting or into the sun, your image will most probably suffer from low contrast. Too much contrast can lend a certain unrealistic look to your image, avoided most often unless you especially want a certain kind of look, and it also make colors appear more saturated in pictures. In most simple editing software you'll again have sliders to help manage the level of contrast. Again you can experiment till an optimal setting intuitively come to you. In Photoshop and some other image editing software, you can use Level tools and Curve tools for this same function.



Level Tool